## 5.7 Epilepsy*

| Assessment | Nursing Diagnosis | Plan / Expected Outcome | Nursing Interventions | Evaluation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Subjective**<br>• "I forget to take my tablets."<br>**Objective**<br>• Seizures becoming more frequent<br>• Drug level below range | **ACTUAL**<br>Ineffective health self-management related to irregular use of antiepileptic drugs as evidenced by missed doses and increased seizure frequency. | • Takes her medicine every day, with fewer seizures. | • Explain why regular dosing matters.<br>• Suggest reminders and a pill organizer.<br>• Teach the usual triggers: lack of sleep, alcohol, missed doses.<br>• Warn her never to stop the drug suddenly. | • Achieved as seizures become less frequent. |
| **Subjective**<br>• "People are afraid of me."<br>**Objective**<br>• Withdrawn<br>• Avoids school or work | **ACTUAL**<br>Inadequate social connectedness related to the stigma of seizures as evidenced by withdrawal. | • Names people who support her and takes up one social activity again. | • Encourage her to talk about her feelings.<br>• Teach the family about epilepsy and seizure first aid.<br>• Refer to an epilepsy support group. | • Outcome reached once sources of support are named. |
| **Subjective**<br>*No specific complaint*<br>**Objective**<br>• Seizure disorder<br>• Two seizures this month | **RISK**<br>Risk for physical injury as evidenced by risk factors: seizure activity. | • Patient and family can describe seizure first aid. | • Teach the family to protect the head, put nothing in the mouth, use the recovery position once jerking stops, and time the seizure.<br>• Advise against swimming alone and against driving until allowed. | • Considered met when first aid is described correctly. |

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [48], [98]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.